Yojana (PMMVY), started in January 2017. As many as 15.4 million pregnant women enrolled for maternity cash transfers as part of this scheme between 2017 and 2020. Of these, 13.8 million women received cash benefits. They each received payments of ₹4,138, on average, in their bank accounts.[110] Additionally, the government amended the Maternity Act in 2017 to increase maternity leave for women working in establishments with over ten employees from the earlier requirement of twelve weeks to twenty-six weeks.[111] As Modi reminds his listeners often in public meetings, this means 'half a year, six months. When the world's developed countries hear what a developing country like ours has done and taken such a big decision for women, even they must be feeling what a wonder this is. They must be surprised. More so that we have mandated creches in offices with more than fifty employees.'[112]

The second milestone is education. For this, Modi often counts three schemes, the first of these being Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao, for educating girl children and to improve India's sex ratio. Initially tested in 140 districts, the scheme was extended to 640 districts in 2017.[113] Ministry of Health data shows that one of its targets—India's Sex Ratio at Birth—improved from 918 in 2014-15 to 931 in 2018-19.[114] Under Swachh Bharat, over 107 million household toilets were built nationwide between 2014 and 2020.[115] Revealingly, from a gender point of view, Modi in 2017 lauded Swachh Bharat toilets as 'Izzat Ghar' or House of Respect after seeing this title-plate being used on toilets in Varanasi by the UP government. In October 2017, the Union government issued a circular to all states, asking Hindi-speaking states to start formally referring to Swachh Bharat toilets as 'Izzat Ghar' and non-Hindi speaking states to come up with similar nomenclature in regional languages.[116] Finally, the Sukanya Samriddhi scheme was launched in December 2014. It allows parents to save money for girl children under the age of ten by depositing a minimum of ₹250, which matures after twenty-one years at an 8.1 per cent interest rate. Over 1.7 crore Sukanya Samriddhi accounts were opened between 2014 and 2019, with 25,979.6 crore being deposited in them till 2018.[117]